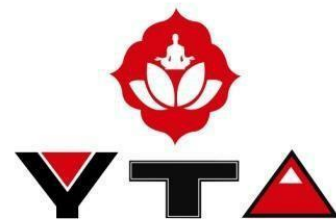




NEWSLETTER



From the Editor in Chief's desk:

By Swami Paranand Tirth

EDITOR IN CHIEF: SWAMI PARANAND TIRTH

Revelations and revelation-ability from esoteric and exoteric stand points.

The third testimony of evidence or agama generally understood as the revelations are also interpreted as आप्तवाक्यम् or the dictums of an authentic agency. Authenticity has been defined as a total absence of delusion or misreading, fraudulence and imperfections relating the means of knowledge including the apparatuses of perfection and cognitions. This however demands a great deal of intellectual subservience and any suspicion about the authenticity or competence of the instruments of knowledge, actual or intellectual, would be a great risk. Error, aberration or fallacy as it were is not pardonable in the parlance of ascertaining

purport we are referring to the purport of the revelations or the dictum of a competent authority -of the description we have already mentioned above. We have three options available for ascertaining the ultimate purport, firstly an individual venture into the labyrinthine conduit of the rational complexities of the scriptures which even from the perspective of a prodigious genius is neither consistent nor possible. The other alternative is a team work as we have in most of the corporate undertakings these days. It works and if executed properly with due procedural precision minimises errors up to a tiny negligible fraction per million strategies -the six sigma method ! In this option specially in an oriental context we have a great disadvantage of the conflict of so called collective self assertion of so many creeds and dogmas. The very existence of their voluminous bulk speaks for their reluctance to meet the other credos at some point or other instead the reciprocation of their self justification, at times at the cost of a blatant rejection of all other schools of thought through dry reasoning. The third alternative has a tinge of mysticism and intuitive insight. This follows from an affiliation with the lineage of uninterrupted conveyance of knowledge specially that of the metaphysical commitment. An esoteric discipline is inevitable in this context. Let us analyse an epistemological paradox in the Gita. This knowledge must be concealed from a determinist who has not been pennant or tolerant, who is not devout that is to say an aspirant of no intellectual subservience. It mustn't be revealed to a man who wouldn't even learn it properly due to an innate avarice for me I.e. Due to his reluctance in accepting me as the

universality and exactitude of the ultimate purport. By the term

ultimate authority in the matters pertaining to transcendental

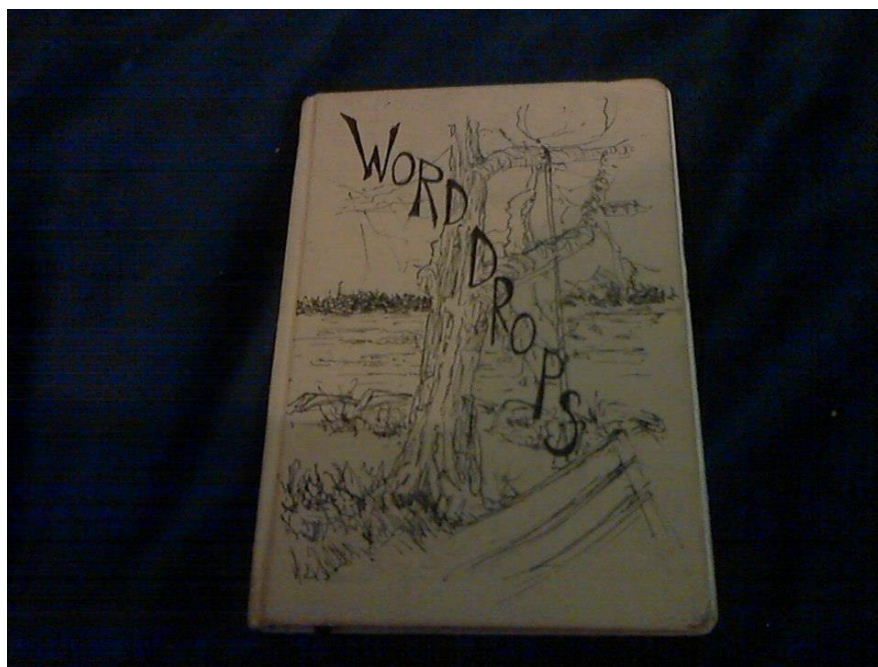
nature. Most of the skeptics come from these three categories and that renders them incompetent for the acquisition of any knowledge. They always get the scriptures wrong and pursue their erroneous understanding only to add to their misgivings. Not being competent even for refuting not to speak of assimilating the purport. This is where esotericism became an integral part of metaphysical cogitation. A man who has not ceased his vicious inclination, who is not placid and tranquil cannot attain this wisdom just because he is intelligent says one of the Upanishads. The type of intelligence it takes is not just an enhanced intelligence quotient but the one that accrues from a considerable

refinement and essential purity. It may not be possible for an individual to cultivate all these virtues through individual effort therefore a "cult" that facilitates this sine quo none is inevitable. Due to an admixture of self styled mysticism and Mystics plus the so called hidden agendas camouflaged by pseudo spiritual masses the term "cult" has nothing praise worthy left in it. Albeit it did have a direct affiliation with culture and cultivation in the hoary past, at least in an etymological sense.

Swami Paranand Tirth
Founder pres.CEO of YTA Yogtantra And Agama(inc.)

A participatory transmission through casual sincere discussions in the form of collaborative sketches, words and sentences [a performative note book!]

By: Suva



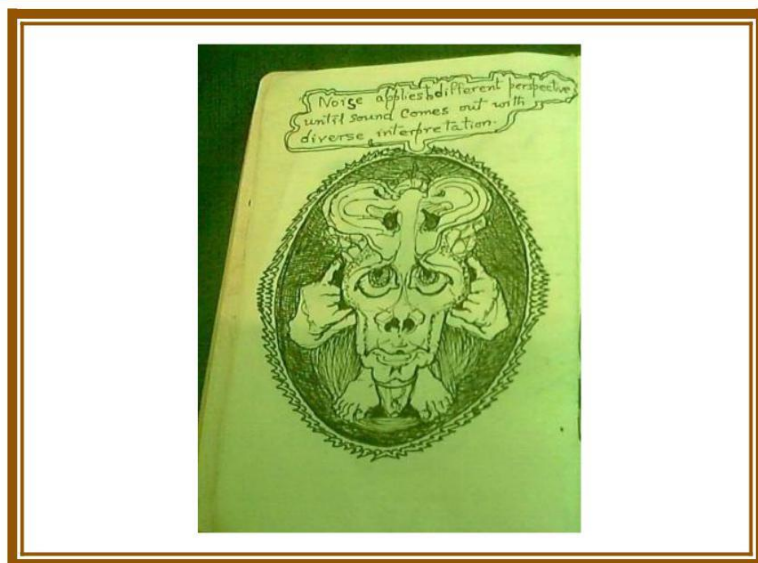


Editorial

While on one hand post globalization world has shrunk into a global village with easy access to information on the other it has tend to become more materialistically oriented making us independent islands in ourselves. A holistic system of knowledge, earlier a part of sacred traditions all over the world has and is being divided into fragments with custodians of one having no clue about the other resulting into total disjointed notion of knowledge. Such secluded and myopic studies may be useful to launch a certain technology or product but often fall flat on its face when explored in-depth. It is then that experts opine sciences are at nascent stage and need many more new discoveries to understand the complex systems and give all the required answers.

Much awaited answers are not going to come from anywhere. The clue lies in the interconnectedness of knowledge systems which we have conveniently narrowed down to make it a hand maiden performing certain stipulated tasks for us. By limiting the scope of knowledge acquired we are limiting ourselves and narrowing down our own infinite potential.

The moment one realizes this vast underpinning connectedness and a need for holistic understanding one has embarked on a journey as a seeker, as someone who refuses to get satisfied by time bound theories which survive till another more sophisticated ones are proposed, only to be refuted. With the blessings of our guru Swami Paranand Tirthji we at YTA have tried to assimilate knowledge from various sources and present this integrated and interdisciplinary approach and connect those dots which we have left secluded and many of them unattended in our material pursuits. We start this issue with an editorial by Swami Paranand Tirthji which throws considerable light on the notion of Revelations and revelation-ability and importance of esoteric traditions for acquiring true knowledge. This is followed by



Swamiji's article on the hidden meaning pervading the spoken and written language. Giving the analogy of the third vowel of Sanskrit script and 'kamakala' Swamiji asserts the importance of language as a subtle form of grosser creation. Next we have Ambika Talwar's informative piece on Creative Resonance & Energy Medicine for Wholeness exploring energy medicine and processes as ways to access the Point of Origin of diverse illnesses or imbalances, which are often triggered by thought forms. Next we have an interesting and analytical write-up by Niraj Kumar on the significance of 'lotus' in Indian and other eastern traditions. The author observes that apart from the simile of lotus used to describe the rising from the samsara & achieving full blooming Enlightenment, it apparently contains the properties of an —Enlightened Being|| unto itself and goes on to analyze it in detail.

The detailed verse to verse transliteration of the Persian poem

'Huma asli Maheshwar bood' attributed to Ali Mardan Khan, an Afghan governor by Rashneek Kher reinforces the belief that spiritual experiences are not bound by any language, religion or nationality. The enchantment he felt at having a vision of Shiva along with Parvati made him write this devotional poem though he himself was a devout muslim. An experiential piece on the 'essence of Nada' by Suva, a performance artist and a musician is a thorough insight in sound systems and the impact they create in our lives. Many scholars have already interpreted words and notations of sound in myriad textual frames. Suva illustrate more on the essence of sound that touched him through his visual, performative and performance practice in the various phases of his artistic growth. Also included in this issue are Suva's drawings from a project titled 'Word Drops'

In the end we have a photo essay featuring various sculptures of Lord Dakshinamurti from Pallava and Chola era by Geetika Kaw Kher.

(Dr. Geetika Kaw Kher is Asst. Professor at Amity School of Fine Arts (ASFA) and teaches History of Art, Aesthetics and Art Criticism)

Wisdom from Shiva's rattle-drum. 3

Swami Paranand Tirth

॥ अइउण ् ॥१॥

अकाय् ब्रह्मर् न् स्मन्न्ननग् गण्

सव् वस् तगषग ।

चित्कर्ामभि उण श्वय ॥३॥

सम्चित्तम जगद्रन

अ Is the embodiment of Brahman which is attribute less and pervades all entities . इ denotes the digit of the moon of consciousness उण ् is the substratum and the grosser manifestation of the universe .

Given that all notions are basically intellectual and all ideals are caricatured on the edifice of expressions which in turn converge in the order of passages , sentences , words and alphabet -the entire gamut of the expressible word is syllabic .

ताण्डमभहाराहभण says that एका या वैवाक . Speech is monosyllabic . Upavarsa the preceptor of Panini maintained that वण् एवतगशब्दाः syllables verily are the words . Panini how ever

did not seem to have shared this theory of his guru but the Agamas pertaining to a discreet tradition did maintain this as a corollary of the main descriptive linguistic doctrine of Patanjali. The monosyllabic theory of the origin of word is more authentic when it comes to the first syllable of the first aphorism of the Maheshwar Sutras . The first vowel of sanskrit language is the personification of the absolute brahma . The first and the last rung of the ladder of expression is this vowel . According to one hearsay tradition this syllable pervades the entire vak or speech. Like the absolute Brahman entire word and meaning synopsis emanates from this , is sustained by this vowel and merges into this syllable . Just as the reticulum of veins pervade the entire leaf says one of the Upanishads onkara pervades all expression. Onkara in turn is pervaded by this first component I.e. Akara. hence the conceptualisation of this syllable as the expression of the absolute Brahman .

The form of Brahman in this context is shabd Brahman or the notion of Brahman with the predominance of the word part of it rather than its meaning counterpart . Ankara as it were pervades all other two syllables I.e. U and m .

Embodiment of the formless beyond attributes: The digit of consciousness

Consciousness defined in terms of lunar digits with their alphabetic reference

The fourth or tritya includes both brevis as well longa (tenuous and soleum)

One of the most arcane syllables that has almost all disciplines of learning encrypted in it is this fourth vowel with a nasal .chitkala

root of this can be traced back into the rik veda

मईशण् तमरक्त् तत (ऋगवेदः)

शण

One who listens to this word of God listens to the truth . The vedas and the eternal word within

This eternal word resonates within the ether of consciousness , of what avail is vedic erudition to those who do not know this ? One school of mysticism opines that the vedas as a latent stream of awareness is omnipresent and reverberates within all sentient creatures . The conventional study of the vedas is fruitful only if it culminates into the recognition of the Vedas within .

भगखिबफदि ् तवा कगिग्गगभधः (सौ म्द रहय्)

ि क

Figurative depiction according to sharada characters

In the sharada characters this third vowel of sanskrit alphabet is written as a T with a curve like J and two dots with another one on top of them . This gives the analogy of a damsels mouth two breasts and the lower portion or pudenda . The figurative form of Kamakala or chitkala is compared to the whole universal as a feminine figure .

Fire being the mouth , the sun and the moon as the two breasts . A similar notion of this Kamakala is also traced in the asyavamiya suktam of the rikveda . One learned scholar from Srinagar told me that he had a sharada manuscript with a vamachar commentary of this suktam . It never reached me but from the word of mouth I learnt that it was about the semblance of Kamakala or the third vowel and nasal accent with the sacrificial pots or िभ placed inverted as the breasts of Kamakala the pudenda being analogous to the sacrificial fire and the face resembling another place at the sacrificial pyre .

आदद्ाि्त्तववर्ासर्ारसतम्ा त्ास्ाि्त्तगय् म्ा तग
म्ा

क र् इ क्

तमजगतर्िव्वजमत्वेवेदाि्त्

व धयः)

ववद्भम् (नथ

is not different from Kamakala or the digit of will or desire the

Kamakala as the substratum of all learning and wisdom.

O mother your display of grandeur manifests in the form of the divergence of fifty odd syllables ,beginning with **अ** and ending at

ॐ . The mystic encryption ,the third vowel has the entire three fold universe,along with all faculties of knowledge i.e. Veda dormant in it

मन् ननतम्ेतव काभय्ाजभनयि

भिर्ा्यित्नष्करि

ततस्ायस्वतमभतमवैततववयरःकन् शिफग

धशि्ेद्धवग व आखम्ानि

प्रततनव् सतमतनसा मतकीत्

मित्े द् ववज्ाः

प््रायि ब्ेप्रणव्ास्नदि प्रणतमत्ान् तव् चियि तत

स्पग टभ ॐ (रघगस्तवः)

If there is some scholar of great erudition upon this earth
He knows this syllable as devoid of **क** and **र** as the source of all learning .

There must have been a tradition of reciting this instead of pranav or omkara before the commencement of vedic recitation

,in some branch of rikveda which seems to have passed into oblivion . The mention of this tradition is to place this in the same sacred place as omkara itself .

This syllable resonates spontaneously in the hearts of all sentient

being but the notion of this as the substratum of the universal phenomena must dawn upon an aspirant by the munificence of the preceptor which is a rare occurrence . This is rather like bridge between the rational and supra rational zones of awareness which are also called as **उभय** and **सम** mind sets of conditioned and unconditioned consciousness .

For a divergent out flux of creation the Lord specified by **अ** the first vowel resorts to his otherwise innately indistinguishable **चचकरा** or the power of consciousness. This has been so meticulously encrypted in various vedic and agamic canons and can be intuitively experienced as the pure and absolutely convergent ,subjective conscious ness .

उ or **उण** ् is called as the universal manifestation of the absolute principle after he unites with his —digit of consciousness|| . Bereft of his maya there is only the absolute unconditioned principle, conditioned in maya he is ishwara or God the creator .

One of most ingenious commentators of Madhusudan Saraswatis gloss on the

crux of entire eastern metaphysics.

Gita has described this very phenomena in the propitiatory verses

आनन्दैक्यसेचिदात्मन

नयब्रह्मण् मगभाशर्षतः

मर्शवम् वत्

शवयेतममबधमैकात्तितक मग

न्तेत्तान्स् थततः तस्मैकस् म मशवस्म

भातमकगगणप्

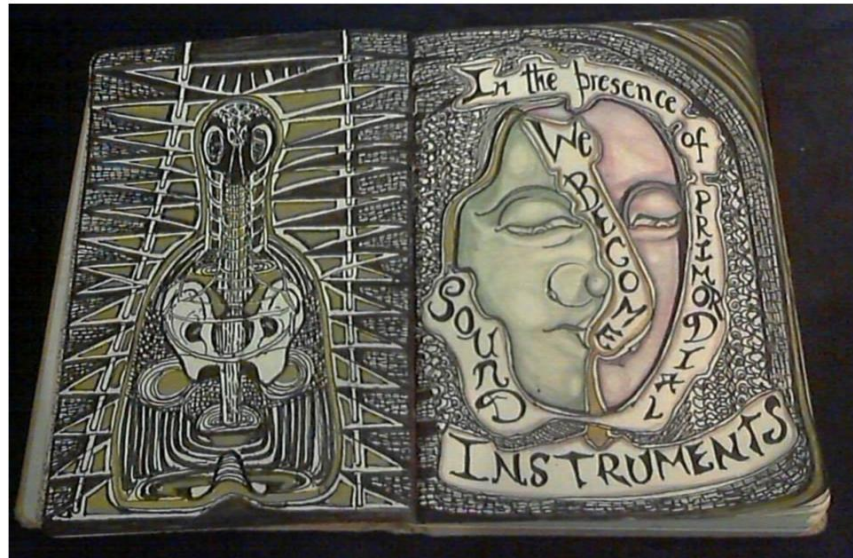
द्धामसब्देदात्न्यात् ववशव्

तनतमवन्मभतभात् भ तत् रम्

त्तात् नगभः

A unique situation arises as the blissful and conscious Brahman unites with Uma . The absolute principle is attributed with lordship and the singular Shiva in the process trifurcates to accomplish creation sustenance and dissolution . In the first beat of his rattle-drum the Lord has

confined the mystery of creation and en passant the



Creative Resonance & Energy Medicine for Wholeness

~ Ambika Talwar

Abstract: This essay explores energy medicine and processes as ways to access the Point of Origin of diverse illnesses or imbalances, which are often triggered by thought forms for we live in a cosmic soup of thoughts, feelings, emotions, memories, et al. We understand illness or disease to be a result of confusion and inappropriate management of information in/by diverse systems of body-mind-spirit and psyche. Once we access the Point of Origin and eliminate recurring/causal confusions and false beliefs/associations, we can with ease regain our state of wellbeing or wholeness.

Creative Resonance & Energy Medicine for Wholeness

~ Ambika Talwar

realize

upon waking

what is truly important...

Here are some oft-asked questions: How does energy healing work? What is energy healing? Isn't everything energy? So I attempt to explore a process of energetic medicine. Having studied diverse modalities and finding what clicked for me, I formed a system by merging these into a process I call *IE: Intuition-Energetics*.

There is nothing cutting edge or earth-shattering about this, but, as a creative person, I see the process of unfolding into wellness also as creative.

Yes —everything|| is energy, and matter is just dense. Thought forms, pulses, sound, light are energy frequencies. We operate with them/are them. We also each operate at our own unique frequency of various resonances. So you may resonate with one shade of blue and I might prefer another — these are a matter of taste but also frequency coherence with who we are. These are subject to change.

Soup of thought forms...

So what do energy and wellness have to do with each other? We each are complex systems of inter/intra-related systems of frequencies and forms, even those yet unknown or unnamed to particles, atoms, cells, tissue, organs, system; and we operate in universes with trillions of these. Imagine, if you will, that we live in an idea-sphere – a soup of thought forms, feelings, emotions, and impressions as energy frequencies. Add to this inter/intra soup of electrons, protons, neutrons, air/radio-waves, and radiation that surround us.

You get the picture of our enormity though we are each also a drop in the ocean. Given that we are multiplicities within multiplicities, the dynamic of being well and coming into wholeness is well served by full-spectrum healing modalities, one of which I offer.

Yes, we are affected by thoughts (ours and others' even if they aren't alive). Sometimes our thinking weakens us, for we get caught with over-thinking (confusion). And knowledge, which must free us, but filtered with untruths, has created terror through minds of devious folk. Media and memory of old wounds continue our programming if we have not cleared the **crud**.

An example: A single negating thought you felt even at age 5 (for instance) or how you were criticized for the way you sat has now resulted in your hips being out of alignment. You go from chiropractor to another for an adjustment. Some people resort to painkillers because their worldview will not allow them to go beyond the confines of the value system in and with which they were raised. Chiropractic work will get you back in form, but even this can be temporary. This doesn't mean you shouldn't seek diverse modes of care. Would I give up forms of massage that integrate my body in lovely ways?

Diverse healing modalities offer us ways to access the point of origin (let's call it —poo||) of a particular issue, to sort through the problem of hip misalignment (in this example), and then to resolve it. In this case, let us become neutral to the wounding from criticism about your gait or carriage or posture (even seated). If this is not enough, let us also clear the effects of negating thoughts for so many years about your physical self, even becoming judgmental about how others sit, as it reminds you of yours. For, through no fault of yours, you created an energetic system to support this misalignment from that one single perception, perhaps a karmic pattern of not being aligned with your self.

Such conditions can be corrected through full spectrum healing modalities by reviewing the diverse influences that created and

supported it. Once clear we integrate into our new structure. It is necessary to also clear our perceptions about imbalance.

Shall we then perceive ourselves in our beauty and wholeness— our true self?

No on positive thinking...

Know that —positive thinking|| will not necessarily correct an issue. Positive thoughts are affirmations. You might say, —Whenever I eat an apple, I get a headache. || This is a statement that affirms something, creating a belief that can be false. So positive statements can be false beliefs.

What is preferable is to find the real cause of a headache, for eating an apple cannot bring it on. But a memory perhaps is triggered. For example, you were eating an apple when you heard your parents have a violent quarrel or you saw a horrific scene on TV, and you happened to have an apple in your hand. Immediately, you made a false association.

Let's correct such associations and free the poor apple of blame. Once we get to the truth, we can move along, and we can enjoy an apple without it getting stuck in our throat, and without you having issues around speaking your truth, about being creative, about singing, about living a full life. A single moment can create sets of false beliefs and false associations.

We accept false beliefs frequently and we have media to add to it. I understand one of the main causes of illness is confusion.

Imagine a ball of wires caught in a mesh and information getting lost in the jumble. Add to this the propagation of mis-information—more confusion as one byte contradicts prior bytes. For example, coffee has been drunk for ages. Suddenly some researchers —find|| it affects your brain adversely by raising stress levels. Everyone is in a scramble to find an alternative. Doctors tell you to lay off that —caffeine.||

Two years later, coffee isn't so bad. Now we find coffee assists central nervous system maintenance. Know also that coffee enemas are used often in the treatment of cancers. But many are on —fake|| coffee: *Here, the finest beverage that tastes just like coffee.* Darn! I love my morning coffee to have a little dust in it. It must be strong and textured—a sweet morning pleasure makes me smile.

Get the picture?

Change program be free...

Even though we know, —Truth shall set us free,|| we are unclear about what truth is. So easily are we programmed for lies (offers of the right cure, Shangri-La or a promised land, false promises to our vanity, or the final solution to peace), that we are prey to misinformation and false beliefs.

Why do we senselessly give up our power to falsehood? Does your body not feel traumatized by systemic untruths? Would you not be empowered by truths so you could create a beautiful life of

wisdom, generosity and love?

Let us remove layers of programmed misinformation and come to a correct understanding of our selves, so be less triggered by confusions, rejections, and overwhelm. Let us peel away layers of dissatisfactions, so the dark underworld of thought forms and emotions have less power on our wellbeing. Once we are cleared of old programs, we can more easily be in command of our emotional wellbeing.

Then misinformation which shows up in a backache, a headache, a splintered toe, an itchy forehead, red eyes, misaligned hip, hair loss, tense relationships, cancerous cells, fear of learning, heart issues, kidney failure, will matter less.

Systems of wellness keep us strengthened to our environments as well. Perhaps, if we don't react to all this mayhem, we will co-create less of it. See yourself as a live organic inter-connected system of inter/intra-related systems, a living causal dynamo or computer with enhanced memory. Somewhere when natural mind re-cognizes this truth as both fixed and flexible, we are rewoven in our resonant wholeness. As perceptions and experiences vary, so we can accept and dance to diversities.

But, we must re-cognize these truths and live them if we are to change our awareness of ourselves as whole and integrated. This resonant connection with True Self, Natural Mind, Big Heart excites our Lovingness, brings us to essence and into our glowing Presence.

Imagine a world of such Presence!

Isn't it time to remove layers of history that brought us to states of ill ease individually and collectively? Isn't it time to learn Love in such a way that we co-create systems resonant with respect and reverence for life? In such a state, perhaps illness would not thrive.

Let us revive memory of our real fulfillment. We know wholeness is an expression of our true nature: a self-determining process of clearing old conditions and arriving at truths, a layer at a time. This deeper layer doesn't have to be down below—it can be up above. More appropriately, it is omni-directional and right in the center is a point of light.

Being a point of light is our responsibility: Let us transform worlds with our presence, a beautiful creative process.

Wholeness is wellness

At our core, we are creative beings. The longing to express our essence (soul and spirit cleansed of past negating influences) and re-form our self is a creative process. Not always easy, it may take longer than we wish, but arriving there is exquisite and elegant.

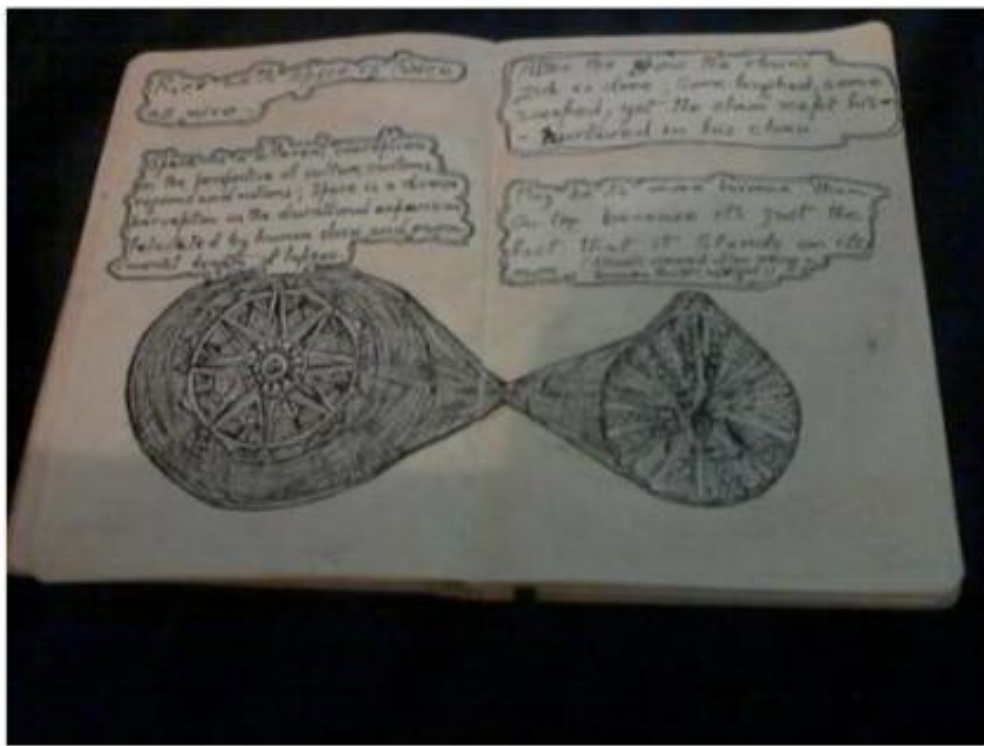
Let us recall the spark of knowing and responsibly realize our wholeness. This inner longing is the beginning of our work to become a creative whole, dancing, resonant being, an integration of Body – Mind – Spirit.

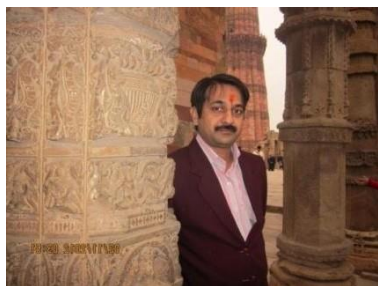
I invite you on this journey to this Vast Emptiness as Wholeness,

so we may choose always to be clear channels of wisdom,
continually arrive as Presence, vibrate as vessel of pleasure at
becoming, and in this cosmic play allow Love to love through us.

© Ambika Talwar/ All Rights Reserved

First published in **NAMAH** Vol. 21, Issue 4, 15th January 2014





Lotus, Full Moon, & Buddha's Enlightenment

Niraj Kumar

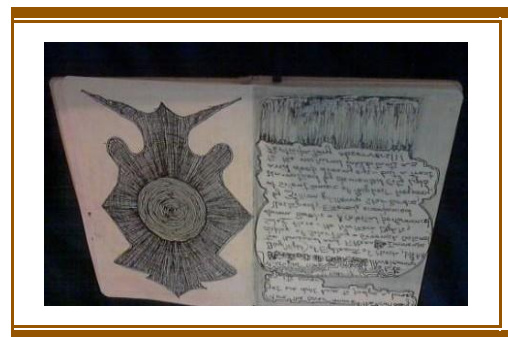
On 4th May, 2015, Buddha Jayanti was celebrated. This is the Buddhapurnima Day (Vesak), the day of Buddha's Enlightenment. Gautama was born on Full Moon, attained enlightenment and died (Mahaparinirvana) on Full Moon. Full

Moon & Buddha's life/legend is deeply intertwined. It is said that after five auspicious dreams and 6 years of wandering, at the age of 35; when he sat under the sacred fig tree (Peepal tree) at

Bodhgaya, with a vow that he won't get up without knowing the Truth; there was tremor of joy across universe. He passed through 49 days of meditation and four stages of consciousness. Finally, he achieved True knowledge, the wheel of karma, law of causation and the eight-fold noble path to cross the cycle of transmigration. With the full moon rising, his mind passed through various states and before the dawn, he gazed at the morning star and realized that the realization is stable and permanent like this morning star in the vast sky. In Buddhist symbolism, blossoming lotus describes metonymically the arising of Buddha-nature. Full Moon, lotus and Buddha nature blooms in structural resonance.

I am deeply engrossed comprehending the underlying connection of symbolism and events and discourses. Gautama's eight fold path, Panini's eight fold realm of matricakra concerning origin of linguistic universe, eight-fold theory of music, eight kind of rasas in aesthetics, eightfold yoga of Patanjali, eight fold universe of saktis with ninth, the bindu as potentiality) in SriCakra/Tantra, eight planet system of the Sun, propensity of atom to gain stability with 8 electron in valance shell, eight-fold symmetry as the potential highest solution for a United Field Theory in mathematics seems to be entrained at some common junction.

Similarly, Gautama's Four Noble Truths with the fourth as the way to transcend the first three reveals the four-fold structure of being as well as language in Indic system. Vedic rishis discovered 'catusyapad' as the way to comprehend the reality. There are set of threes and the fourth as the way to transcend. Fourth is the turiya. Three gunas, three purushartha, three Vedas, three states of consciousness, three-fold division of Kala(time) and so on. And the fourth in each aspect signifies the transcendence. Gautama's Four-fold Truth is encapsulated in similar structure. Fourth is the way to transcend and as found in



Indic tradition the Way is always Eight-fold. I am tempted to put therefore Gautama's awakening as the awakening of a Vedic seer reiterating the Truth discovered by the predecessors.

But, whereas Vedic seers were more engaged with the sun and fire in their approach towards rituals, it is strange that Buddha's disciples took up the opposite, —Moon and water|| to symbolize their own way of liberation. Hence, we find how in Buddha's legend, the blooming Moon is projected as the defining characteristic of important events.

Lotus (*Kamala*, Botanical name *Nelumbo nucifera* Gaertn) has always been a sacred flower in the East due to its peculiar properties. Most of us are aware that it grows in muddy water, moves upward towards light. Above the surface of dirty water, it blooms. Buddha used the simile of lotus to preach the virtue of purity, emergence and achievement. It is interesting that Buddha is shown as sitting on a lotus flower in Lotus position (Padmasana) with a lotus in hand and a 1000-petalled lotus blooming in head. Like Full Moon, lotus encapsulates Buddha's enlightenment. Both symbolisms converge in head. Buddha saw 1000 Full Moon in life. He departed at the age of 80 (~1000 full moons). Buddha with thousand-petalled lotus blooms had auspicious experience of thousand full-moon night.

I am particularly surprised with the recent advances in unraveling biological properties of lotus. Lotus is a unique plant that regulates the temperature without any neuro-endocrinal system as found in the warm-blooded animals like human beings. Surprisingly, the temperature range is very narrow (86-95 degree F). Lotus is exceptional in increasing oxygen intake and release of more carbon dioxide at night used in converting more carbohydrate to energy just like warm-blooded animals do during cold. This heat production tapers off at the dawn. Seventy lotus flowers can produce as much heat as a human body.

Lotus has another property to self-cleanse. Microscopic structure on lotus leaf creates a water-repellant surface. Raindrops can't

stick and these roll off cleansing the dust. This property has been termed as —lotus-effect|| in the field of nano-technology. Now, nano-engineers as well as NASA rocket scientists want to harness this property of lotus to create a self-cleansing toilet, rocket shell, clothes etc.



Lotus seeds are also known for its endurance and permanence. Lotus seeds have been found dormant for thousand years and then suddenly sprouting into a healthy plant. This property is under investigation to learn more about anti-ageing properties. Lotus pod looks like human heart and on blooming like the cerebral surface. Heart contains the potentiality to bloom into full awakening of mind.



Apart from the simile of lotus used to describe the rising from the samsara & achieving full blooming Enlightenment, it is apparent that lotus contains the properties of an —Enlightened Being|| unto itself. It rises from beneath and immediately returns back to the source. With the bloom, it prepares to shed the seeds, like an enlightened being who is active to propagate virtue. The flowers and the plants rise with the dawn and set in the dusk in consonance with solar rhythm and yet are active during night by producing more heat attracting countless insects. When other plants sleep, lotus is active and awake and helps the needy multitude with warmth like a compassionate Being. Each part of lotus is edible and useful. May it be rhizome, roots, stem, flower and seed just like the full utility of an Enlightened being in every aspect. For the welfare of the world, lotus continue to self-cleanse, a virtue aspired by seekers. Surprisingly, lotus maintains temperature which is in the range of an Enlightened being i.e. slightly below normal human temperature due to the cooling caused by secretions when the energies awaken each part of brain (*shithlikaran*). The sign of an enlightened being is hypothermic condition described as the —cool shower of the Moon|| in scriptures and esoteric tradition. This happens due to a coherence of cells at highest level that entails maximum efficiency of energy

and minimum production of heat. If one sees the open pod of lotus flower that contains seed in honey-comb structure, this looks similar to the image of thousand-petalled lotus bloom in the head of a Buddha. From seed to flower, lotus contains same property of blooming, self-purification, attraction and utility. Seeds contain the secret of immortality. Lotus symbolizes flowerification of Perfect Being.

This is the reason that India, the land of spiritual fervour, has adopted Lotus as the National Flower. The Vedic seers mention the flower under the name of Pundarika. In Hindu cosmogonic myths, lotus is associated with the creator Prajapati. In The Mahabharata, the creator God, Brahma, is mentioned as having sprung from the lotus that grew out of Vishnu's navel. Lotus is also known as the *Sripushpa*- the auspicious flower. The Srividya sadhna which is the highest ritual worship of the universal creatrix in the form of Mother Goddess amply demonstrates the auspiciousness of the flower. The deity holds the flower in her hands. In fact, iconographic representation of almost every female deity in Indic tradition shows a lotus bud in the hand.

Lotus is also associated with supernatural birth. The bud appears as a human womb. The Second Buddha, Padmasambhava is said to be lotus-born. There are plethoras of birth-stories associated with the lotus flower. In fact, the mythological land of immortal sages is said to be abundant in lakes filled with lotus. Lotus is associated with the idea of immortality not only in Indic tradition, but also in other world-cultures. It has something to do with the transformation of lotus into the shape of cobra upon its death. Even in death, the lotus inspires. It is not without symbolic underpinning that Kundalini, the cobra-shaped esoteric energy that can take a seeker to the realm of immortality, is assumed to pierce the lotus-cakras of a yogi/tantric. And in this symbolism is condensed the Indian spiritual wisdom!

Bionote: Niraj Kumar is associated with Society for Asian Integration. He is a disciple of Swami Ranganathanandaji Maharaj of Ramakrishna Mission.



‘Huma Asli Maheshwar bood’

Rashneek Kher

Not many people in Kashmir would have known the name, Ali Mardan Khan, had it not been for the small area in downtown Srinagar that is named after this Afghan Governor. Despite this he would have remained a name in the books of history like many others rulers but for the verses that immortalized him in Kashmiri Folklore, despite him not being a Kashmiri. The verses were written at a time which was clearly our dark ages. It was forbidden for non Muslims (read Hindus) to read their scriptures or practice their religion openly. I am not sure if it is entirely true but it is widely believed that the Hindus were ordered not to recite Sanskrit verses thus forcing them to make Persian as their language of connect to their deities. Whatever may be the historical accuracy of this —order||, to this day we recite Bhakti verses in Persian and there is one in particular which I remember and goes something like this:

Chakreshwari Hajat rawa, Sajath gada ra padshah

Vaah Vaah chi Lakshmi Thapna, shree sharika devi nama

That Goddess Chakreshwari, who can turn a beggar into a king

She who listens to our prayers and answers them

I salute, thee, Seat of Lakshmi, who incarnates in the form of Sharika (in Kashmir)

To cut a long story short, one evening Ali Mardan had a vision which took the shape of a beautiful Persian Devotional Poem

.Most of us keep reciting them at religious and social festivals with fervor & devotion. Thanks to the oral tradition that has helped carry this poem in its totality to us. It also is a commonplace in most of our Leela* renditions. I am using the version published in Sahaj Kosam (compiled by Moti Lal Saqi)

for Mast Bab Ashram. It is slightly different from the version (the last verse differs) that comes down to us via the oral route .I make an attempt to transliterate the verses.

Huma Asli Maheshwar Bood, Shab Shahi ki Man Deedam

Ghazanfar Charma-e-barbood, Shab Shahi Ki Man Deedam.

It was Shiva, the real God, the King I saw that night

Adorned was his body with Lion Skin, the King I saw that night

Ze Basmash Jam-e-bar-tan, Zunar-ish mar-e-bar garden

Ravanish Gang-e-bar sarbood, Shab Shahi.....

Besmearred with ash, Instead of the scared thread a snake coiled around his neck

Un ebbd flows the Ganga from his locks, the King I saw that night

Seh Chashmash bar-jabee-daarad, Zi mahro maaha roshan tar

Se Karan Daste-Bastah Bood, Shab Shahi.....**

Brighter than sun and moon, shone his three eyes

In Salutations to him stood Vishnu, Brahma and Shiva (the 3 causes of the universe), the King.....

**This verse needs a little explanation, the three reasons though commonly understood as Shiva, Vishnu and Mahesh are seen in a different way by the Saivites of Kashmir. The Will (Iccha Shakti of Citi-Supreme Consciousness) in itself has the triple process of manifesting, maintaining and dissolving the universe. So the three reasons could also be understood as attainment of Swantantraya (Freedom from Bondage of Ignorance)

Be Dastash AAb-e-Kaunsar, Ve bekh Nakoosay Nilofar

Hilalash Taj Bar Sar Bood, Shab Shahi.....

With a conch of Lotus Shoot in one hand and the pitcher of nectar in another

The Crescent Moon embellished his forehead, the King.....

Uma az soi-chip-binger, Zi Sad Khursheed Taban-tar

Savare Kulb-e-nar bood, Shab Shahi.....

Uma on his left, effulgent, like a thousand suns

Beseated on Nandi, I saw the king that night.....

Ajab Sanyasiye deedam, Namō Narayanay Guftam

Be Khakhay Paye Bosidam, Shab Shahi....

Wonderstruck I said Namō Narayan, incredible sage he was

In reverence, I bowed to touch the specks of dust at his feet, the King.....

Nighahay bar mane Miskeen, Namud-e-az- chasme taaban-tar

Makanash La maaken tar bood, Shab Shahi.....

With his divine grace (Anugraha) ,he showered his radiance

Immersed me in the universe of consciousness, the King.....

Manam Mardan Ali Khanam, Ghulam-e-Shahe-Shahanam

Ajab Israr Main Beenam, Shab Shahi.....

I Ali Mardan Khan who is the servant of the king of the kings

Is witness to a mystic experience, the King.....

Another version of the last verse is Manam Marde Musalmanam, Ali Khanam Namee Dhanam, which means

I Ali Mardan a devout Muslim , who owes every breath to Ali (the Caliph).

This poem is also a reiteration of the Kashmiri Saivite standpoint of the world being real as against the Vedantic concept of it being Maya (unreal). That the poet's vision is not of a formless deity but one that he describes in great detail with its physical attributes and iconography reinforces the Kashmiri Saiva thought of the creation being real when Unmesh (broadly translated as opening of eye/thought) happens.

Note: I would welcome improvements in translation. Persian is not a language I am well versed with. I thank my friend Geetika, without her help this translation would not have been possible.

*Leela is a Kashmiri Devotional Poem.

(Rashneek Kher is a Kashmiri poet and a literary critic living in exile in Faridabad)



Painting by Gungun (Via Bhoomi Sati)



ESSENCE OF NADA - PRIMORDIAL SOUND INTO PRACTICE

Suva

When we are born, we relate to the sound. We relate to the touch, smell, emotions, motions and audio-visual registration. We know that these elements appear as decoding tools that evolved long before the words formed out of the primary core - sound. The words that decorate to form a sentence, more or less can be assumed as a compiled refinement of e-motions. Therefore words sit in the secondary mold to cast a spell on the multiplication of diverse differentiation. Gradually humans developed these patterns of lingua franca to highlight the coding system of communication evolving from the sonic space. The distribution of these compact word patterns had been influenced by geographical and cultural palettes, within the umbrella of shifting pigmented civilizations. But in the midst of lingual environment what is the role of sound? How can we discover the essence of primordial sound – *Nada* in our practice and understanding of music? Many scholars have already interpreted words and notations of sound in myriad textual frames. However to proceed further I will illustrate more on the essence of sound that touched me through my visual, performative and performance practice in the chapters of my artistic growth.

My toddler days were nourished with the sensory filaments of sound through music and the intricacies of rhythm. It was far different than the modern day electrified gadgets that are condensed with screens to touch and type. Sound of Vedic hymns, chants from the Buddhist Gumpa, Sunday morning bells from the nearby church and soothing azan resonating throughout the sky, painted an esoteric environment around the vicinities. Then there was the home atmosphere that magnified story telling sessions, sound of common fireplace, aromatic sound of cooking and the sound of affinity among neighbours. These sounds were the primordial space before words demented my being, by refining and defining the queer world of differences through language, customs, compartmental branding in the name of religion, taboos and cultural razors. What was so appealing about such audible colours?

Being amplified by this sonic space, the creative growth of mine often came up with questions, identifying the body of sound. How would one look into the formalistic feature of sound? Is it

possible for us to visually experience the tonal frequency of sound? How can the audible-tonal mood be visually preconceived? These questions may be lyrically answered through an enriching excerpt from the poem – The Brook by Alfred Lord Tennyson :-

— -----
I chatter over stony ways,
In little sharps and trebles,
I bubble into eddying bays,
I babble on the pebbles.

—
(4th stanza)

Tennyson's poem – The Brook, has a phonetic note towards the depiction of sonic velocity. His verses catch the tonal frequency in lucid typographic scales perceiving a dynamic flow of sound. This poem attempts to record a visual interpretation of audible perambulation that this native stream performs. Would it be appropriate to express that Tennyson explores the primordial sound -*Nada*, while recognizing the suchness of experience?

Nada is the Sanskrit word for —sound,|| and meditating on the inner sound means *nada yoga*, also indicates the sound of silence. Coincidentally in Spanish *nada* means —nothing.|| It is understood as a primordial sound, being the essence of life and that which resonates in everything. Nada Yoga system dissects the sound of music into two categories: internal music, *anahata*, and external music, *ahata*. The seat of internal music is the heart chakra area (*anahata*), that hosts the beats of life form and receives the subtle sounds, silent to the mundane ear to hear although one can listen to those in depth. We also have one of the valuable philosophical treatises, known as Sama Veda that represents the rapture and devotion to sound in spiritual practice. Sama Veda is the third scriptural understanding along with Rig, Yajur and Atharva; it is described here that —Sapta Swara|| or seven notes (Sa Ri Ga Ma Pa Dha Ni similar to Western- Do Re Mi Fa So La Ti) were derived from the sound of non-human humane species in their appropriate season. A table below draws a comparison of the seven notes and it's associations, according to the ancient text of music– Naradiya Shiksha (1.5.3; 1.5.4)

Name in Sama Music	Symbol	Sama Veda Svara	Bird/animal Sound associated
Madhyama	Ma	svarita	heron
Gandhara	Ga	udatta	goat
Rishabha	Ri	anudatta	bull
Shadja	Sa	svarita	peacock
Nishadha	Ni	udatta	elephant
Daiwatha	Dha	anudatta	horse
Panchama	Pa	svarita	Cuckoo

These seven notes are complimenting the external flow of music and also has the possibilities to enter the internal space of sound. There is also —rhythm|| that accompanies the rambling notes to keep on the dialogue of sound in its vibration and resonance.

In today's world textual informations on sound of music are in abundance that we can register in our knowledge bank and all the key words are just click away, ready to be captured through the web-net tools. My relation to sound through rhythm and notes pass through transitional phase more aligned to practice and experiencing. The childhood lullabies, rustle of the bamboo trees,

smell of the pine tree saps and sound of dew drops, ringing flow of mountain springs and roar of water falls, the morning and evening walks through the green meadows; all these were inspirations to explore beyond the conventional frame. To detect the inner faculty (primordial essence) there is this strong feeling growing in me to excavate the tactile quality of sound. How can I reach through such an element? It is obvious for me to turn my attention towards construction of sculpture incorporating the unconventional matter, mass or channels. Each sculptural creations gradually evolved into deeper understanding of something in between ! That which is the void or the gap, the micro notes between those, the intricacies of rhythmic timing, the kumbhak (pausing) stage between Puraka (inhalation) and Rechaka (exhalation) in the rhythm of breathing. These experiences are my notations and potential materials. A medium through which I have been cogitating to process my inner insight so that I can share with others. That is where the avid forms of performance and performing comes alive in my creative venture. There is a thin line between performing and performance (Art), the former that relies on rehearsed formats and the later builds up the format while presenting. This is possible for me only through improvisation which helps by knowing the space, material and the participatory observers.

Presently we associate demonstrations on sound with a term called Sound Art and Performance. Usual frame of Sound Art has to do with technological devices in most cases dealing with the noise. Bringing the popular in abstract dimension where noise develops an adrenalin state, but then very often we miss out the organic tincture of the primordial essence of sound. We can imitate but cannot produce the subtle purity which can be expressed through acoustic ways. For example, a jolt of thunder with an immense bass sound cannot be the same, even if one imitates this using electronic devices. When I go through the pathways of deeper sound, the acoustic flow touches those high and low frequency tones in a biomorphic semblance and those resembling sensation blends amiably around the space of presentation.

This brings me to the parallel path of Nada yoga which is an art of using sounds and tones to create inner transformations. We know that all living beings relate to the sound of music. Scientists have been discovering the response of the flora and fauna towards sound vibration which pervades all existing matters. In Indian Classical Music we have methods or styles of singing like Dhrupad and Tarana that chromatically evolves through the outer sound and brings us to the vast space of inner sound. We can find such similarities in Throat singing style of Mongolia, that traverses through undertones and overtones. Overtones are also utilized as a tool for sound healing in music therapy, an alternative treatment procedure which is becoming popular presently throughout the world. Then we have the rhythm section very much present in our bodily mechanism, for instance our heart beats. Can we agree to such a concept, that rhythm evolved from the perambulated timing of our heart complimented by our breathing? In this case we may be aware that our life force is fueled by the application of Nada yogic system. In the practice of Pranayama (breathing technique) one can experience the function of Nada with an effective mudra known as Dhenu

Mudra, combination of overtone and Bhrahmari Pranayam. This is performed while sitting in Siddha-asana (posture) and placing the mudra in each chakra points of our body, the base chakra can be represented by placing the mudra on the base of sitting position. For Music practitioners, this pranayama method intensifies to a concentrating mode where one can experience the true essence of Nada – primordial sound world.



Image of Dhenu Mudra

Being aware of the sacred syllable – Om, the symbol of primordial sound with immense reverence I am coming to the conclusion with a shloka from Mandukya Upanishad -

“Om ity etad aksharam idam sarvam tasyopavyakhyanam bhutam bhavat bhavishyaditi sarvam Omkara eva”

(Om is the imperishable, and it is 'all this'. All this, whatever is visible, whatever is cognisable, whatever can come within the purview of sense-perception, inference or verbal testimony, whatever can be comprehended under the single term of creation all this is Om)

(Suva is a freelance performance artist and a musician based in Finland. Academically trained in sculpture he now teaches Yoga and acoustic drumming and is involved in creating experimental music.)

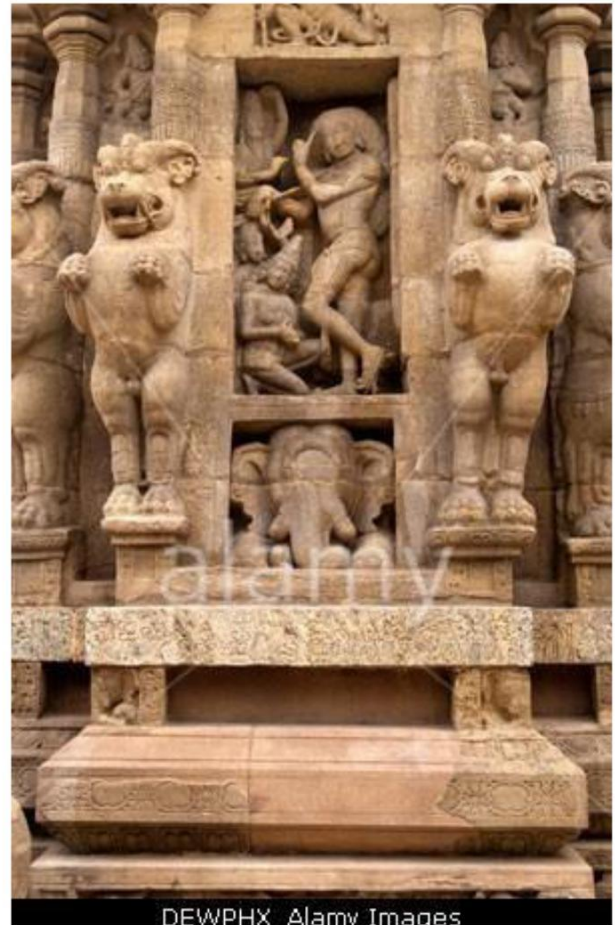
Lord Dakshinamurti: Photo Essay

Dr. Geetika Kaw Kher

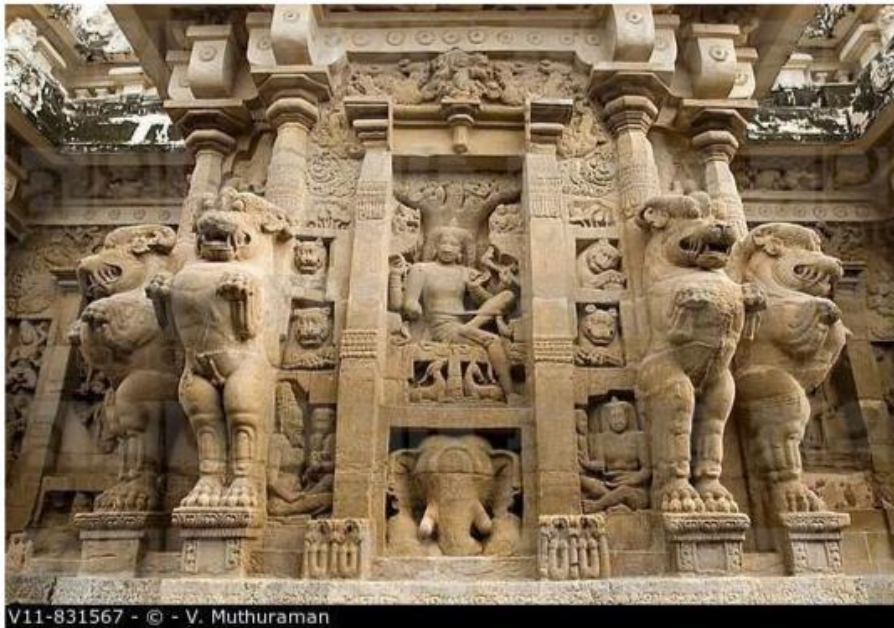


Dakshinamurti Siva, Koranganatha Temple
near Trichy, 7th C A.D, Pallava dynasty

Dakshinamurti Siva, Kailashnath Temple,
Kanchipuram, 8th C. A.D, Pallava dynasty
Patronized by Rajasimha



DEWPHX Alamy Images



V11-831567 - © - V. Muthuraman

**Yoga Dakshinamurti , Kailashnath Temple,
Kanchipuram, 8th C. A.D, Pallava dynasty
Patronized by Rajasimha**



**Dakshinamurti,
Sarguneswara Temple
at Koruvil circa 12th C
AD**

**Dakshinamurti
Siva, 8th C A.D,
Pallava dynasty**



.3



Dakshinamurti Siva, Medium: Granite, 10th C. A.D, Chola Dynasty



Dakshinamurti Siva, Medium: Bronze, 10th C. A.D, Chola Dynasty



NEWSLETTER
YOGTANTRAGAMA



Published by: Rashneek Kher

901-902, Iris Tower, Faridabad, Haryana, 121010. Mail: swamiparanand@gmail.com

Drawings: Rashneek Kher

Logo: Manik Chawla

